# Heavy Rain Floods the Four Corners Region

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Heavy rain that started on Wednesday has caused flooding in the Four Corners region, where New Mexico, Colorado, Utah, and Arizona meet. By Friday, October 23, floodwaters had closed roads, forced **evacuations**, and led to **emergency declarations** in the four states. Forecasters said more rain could come through Sunday.

In San Juan County, New Mexico, Devin Neeley described blue sky above while brown floodwaters filled low-lying homes below. He said the county had not seen flooding like this in generations, and people in vulnerable areas were told to evacuate on Thursday afternoon.

In Hurricane, southern Utah, flooding damaged more than 100 homes and **recreational vehicles**. Navajo Nation police said authorities rescued seven families, 30 people. The Hopi Tribe in Arizona declared a state of emergency, and Colorado Governor Jared Polis declared disaster emergencies for 11 counties.

In Farmington, New Mexico, Police Chief Steve Hebbe said no deaths had been reported, and urged people not to take the flooding lightly. **Meteorologists** said the rain came from the **remnants** of Hurricane Trudy.

## Word Treasure

**evacuations** -- When people have to leave their homes to stay safe.
**emergency declarations** -- An official announcement that an area needs special help.
**recreational vehicles** -- Vehicles people can live and travel in, like a home on wheels.
**Meteorologists** -- Scientists who study weather and predict rain and storms.
**remnants** -- What is left over after something has mostly ended.

## Background you need

The Four Corners region is where four states meet.

Heavy rain can make water rise until it covers roads and fills homes.

When flooding is dangerous, officials tell people to leave unsafe areas and declare emergencies so help can arrive.

## Break it down

**WHO:** People in the Four Corners region, including Devin Neeley, Navajo Nation police, the Hopi Tribe, and Colorado Governor Jared Polis.

**WHAT:** Heavy rain caused flooding that closed roads, forced evacuations, and led to emergency declarations.

**WHERE:** The Four Corners region, where New Mexico, Colorado, Utah, and Arizona meet, including San Juan County, Hurricane, and Farmington.

**WHY:** Rain from the remnants of Hurricane Trudy flooded low-lying areas.

## Why it matters

Floods can close roads and schools near your home, so knowing why people evacuate helps you stay safe when heavy rain comes.

## Test what you remember

**1. Where do New Mexico, Colorado, Utah, and Arizona meet?**

- (A) The Great Lakes
- (B) The Rocky Mountains
- (C) The Four Corners region
- (D) The Gulf Coast

**2. By Friday, October 23, what had floodwaters done?**

- (A) Stopped all trains
- (B) Dried up rivers
- (C) Closed roads, forced evacuations, and led to emergency declarations
- (D) Melted snow on mountains

**3. In Hurricane, Utah, what did flooding damage?**

- (A) More than 100 homes and recreational vehicles
- (B) Farms and barns
- (C) Only schools
- (D) Only bridges

**4. How many people did authorities rescue, according to Navajo Nation police?**

- (A) 30 people
- (B) 7 people
- (C) 100 people
- (D) 11 people

**5. Who said no deaths had been reported in Farmington?**

- (A) Police Chief Steve Hebbe
- (B) Forecasters
- (C) Governor Jared Polis
- (D) Devin Neeley

**6. Where did meteorologists say the rain came from?**

- (A) The Pacific Ocean
- (B) A winter snowstorm
- (C) The Colorado River
- (D) The remnants of Hurricane Trudy

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: C 2: C 3: A 4: A 5: A 6: D

## Questions to think about

1. Devin Neeley: Said the county had not seen flooding like this in generations.
2. Police Chief Steve Hebbe: Said no deaths had been reported and urged people not to take the flooding lightly.
3. Forecasters: Said more rain could come through Sunday.

**MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):**